Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Barb Dwyer

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with **Artie Ficial** and **Chip Patina**.
- **Paige Turner** keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes **Brie DeVivre** revise the service routes. **Brie** would like one final version.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Barb Dwyer. I am security. Please behave as though I have already noticed whatever you are about to try.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Barb Dwyer

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

She has spent her career withholding emotion to avoid appearing vulnerable. A preventable blind spot destroys that defense.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Barb Dwyer

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A champion's keepsake is concealing something beneath its base.*

2 *The red curtains conceal more than the view beyond the window.*

3 *An icy archive is preserving something other than supper.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Barb Dwyer

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Barb Dwyer

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Grant requested privacy from the live monitor. I agreed. A donor gets an exception; security gets the questions afterward. Artie wanted the evening smooth. I wanted the visiting crews out of our way. I know how that sounds. I also know how often people here ask me to be less suspicious, then ask why I didn't suspect something.

IF MURDERER

> Grant requested privacy from the live monitor. I agreed and logged it as an equipment fault. He knew it wasn't. He could use that entry whenever I refused another request. Artie wanted the evening smooth. I wanted the visiting crews out of our way. Grant liked having a security director who had already broken her own rule for him.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Barb Dwyer

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Barb Dwyer

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took the private-room camera off the monitor and kept the outside crew out. Staff and caterers could still come through. I checked the room; Grant's place was set. I wrote fault, not privacy, in the log. When he wanted the room cleared, I cleared it. Artie used it too. Paige, you wanted a record of what happened in there. I had already made that impossible.

IF MURDERER

I took the private-room camera off the live monitor. Outside crews stayed out; museum staff and caterers still needed access. I checked the room. Grant's place was set and nobody was there. I shut the door for a moment to check the latch, then opened it again. The fault entry was false. That exception stayed between me and the technician. Brie, tell me what your staff need. Give me a task. Sitting here is doing nothing for anybody.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Barb Dwyer

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Power. Not network. That's the adapter I had removed. There is no recording, and calling it a fault won't produce one. I also told the technician what to put in the log. Paige, I won't ask you to put your recorder away. I have made quite enough decisions about what gets recorded. Brie, your staff can leave when their shift ends.

IF MURDERER

> The technician removed the network lead. Power stayed connected; it saved locally. I authorized monitor privacy. I wrote fault in the main log, and that was wrong. A recording should remain on the camera. Paige, stop asking me whether I'm certain. I'm certain what I ordered. Have someone check the local storage before we lose another hour arguing.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Barb Dwyer

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Barb Dwyer

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. I ordered the power removed and lied in the log. The technician's work order carries my signature. My own department created a blind spot. I will return the badge while that is investigated. Brie, make sure your staff get home before anybody starts asking them for a convenient version of tonight. They don't owe the museum one.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I turned recording off. The signed work order removes power, not a network lead. I checked the room so I knew where Grant's glass was waiting. I had already taken poison during the preview; I used it at that private place. Then I relied on the privacy exception to conceal the visit. I told you a local recording existed because I wanted the missing footage to sound like a problem we could fix. There is no footage to find. I used a blind spot I created. My department will have to answer for trusting the person who was supposed to keep it honest.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.